Abdullah Al Zahid

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SUMMARY

Transportation engineer with a master's degree and four years across GO rail service planning at Metrolinx and municipal transportation planning at the City of Toronto. Tested GO service changes in simulation against infrastructure constraints and construction restrictions, and works across divisions, agencies and consultants to move issues to a decision.

EXPERIENCE

Assistant Planner, Transportation Planning

City of Toronto | January 2024 – present

- Run assigned studies from scoping through to recommendations, writing the briefing notes that come out of them and presenting to planners, engineers and managers in other divisions.
- Coordinate with divisions, consultants, applicants and outside agencies whose priorities conflict, and work issues through to a position everyone can act on.
- Analyze travel and network data, including several years of the Transportation Tomorrow Survey, to establish where capacity falls short and what that means for future service and investment.
- Built the Transportation Data Dashboard, replacing a report rebuilt by hand each quarter with one validated source the division reports from, and saw the change through to adoption.

Transportation Planner, Simulation and Modelling

Metrolinx, Service Design | February 2023 – January 2024

- Ran OpenTrack simulations of GO rail services to establish what proposed operating and infrastructure changes would do to run times, reliability and recovery before they were taken forward.
- Assessed the service effect of temporary and permanent slow orders, the kind of restriction that construction on an operating railway imposes.
- Worked with schedulers, operations staff and engineers on service design decisions and presented the evidence behind them.

Graduate Transportation Planner

Mott MacDonald | January – February 2023

- Short consulting placement on Ontario Line work. Ran traffic simulations to estimate how construction staging would affect surrounding streets, and prepared the supporting material for the project team.

Graduate Research Assistant

University of Alberta | January 2020 – August 2022

- Master's research on how road networks perform during emergency evacuations, using macroscopic (LWR) and agent-based (MATSim) models.
- Worked with large travel datasets and wrote up results for readers without a modelling background.

SKILLS

Rail service design and simulation: OpenTrack and TrainPlan. Operational effect of construction and speed restrictions. Briefing notes, reports and presentations for senior staff. Coordination across operations, engineering and project teams. Python (Pandas, NumPy), SQL and ArcGIS Pro. MS Office.

EDUCATION

MSc, Transportation Engineering — University of Alberta, 2022

BSc, Civil Engineering — Bangladesh University of Engineering and Technology, 2018

BSc, Computer Science — University of British Columbia, in progress (2025–2027)